Planning the size of portions to be served depends on type of establishment, menu and customer, quality of food and the prices charged.



Plate 2.15 Portion size for Fried Rice

There are several systems of serving food to customers. The prepared food should reach the customers in the most appealing manner and several aspects have to be taken care of before the food reaches the customer. One such aspect is portion control, which is extremely important. This is because portion control has a cumulative effect on food production and service.

Standardized recipes require effective portion control. It is possible by using standard measuring utensils such as ladles, scoops and other equipment. Portion control means giving a definite quantity of good food, well processed and properly served in the right atmosphere for a definite price to ensure a definite margin of profit in return for the money, time, labour and interest that have been expended.

Methods of portion control

- Standard sized pans permit portions to be cut or served as needed.
- Ladles that are labeled in ounces may be used to serve soups, gravies, stews and sauces. The most frequently used sizes of ladles are 2 oz (1/4 cup), 4 oz (1/2 cup), 6 oz (3/4 cup) and 8 oz (1 cup). (I ounce = 30 ml)



Plate 2.16 Soup Ladle

- Serving spoons (solid or perforated) are used for portioning. It is better to measure or weigh food to get an approximate serving.
- Scoops can be used to portion out items like drop cookies, muffins, meat patties, vegetables, salads and sandwich fillings.



Plate 2.17 Ice cream Scoop

- Portion scales can be used for meat or vegetable portions. Weighed samples can be used as an approximate measure.

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